

From Passage 1 [11m for Passage 1's SAQs]

1. According to the author, what are **two** reasons for 'the collapse of the American mall' (line 1)? [2]

From the passage	Suggested answer
1. The most obvious—the rise of online retail—is undeniably a significant factor, (L2) ...Amazon gutted brick-and-mortar (EG of point 1) 2. but it also masks a rot that had been spreading before Amazon gutted brick-and-mortar It is hard to think of any comparable social institution that cost <u>so much</u> and covered <u>so much</u> physical space and then imploded so quickly.	The two reasons are the 1. Emergence/ proliferation/ increasing popularity of e-commerce <i>Idea of upward trend/ growth needs to be present for Point 1</i> 2. (inferred) and the inability of physical malls to keep up / remain relevant. <i>or</i> People also lost interest in / have been apathetic about going to malls <i>or</i> (inferred) Malls became too expensive to maintain. <i>Note: intensifier needed; 'expensive' alone is insufficient</i>
Learning points:	

2. In paragraph 2, explain how the author supports the claim that the idea of the suburban shopping mall ‘was incredibly successful’ (line 8)? [3]

From the passage	Suggested answer
The exodus from urban centers to suburbs created an enormous opportunity to fill a vacuum for goods and services in smaller communities. (L8-10) <i>Note that ‘smaller communities’ is synonymous with ‘suburbs’</i> A mall patron could get their hair styled, buy groceries, visit the bank, and enjoy an art installation all in one building. (L10-11) As the concept gained steam, the mall seemed a well of endless novelty — a preeminent showcase of modern architecture and innovative products. (L11-13)	1. The author supports it by explaining that the suburban mall capitalised on/ exploited the immense consumer demand / need for goods and services. [1] <i>Intensifier needs to be captured in point 1</i> 2. The suburban mall was also capable of providing a wide range of services, located conveniently in the same place. [1] 3. It also appeared to offer items / experiences and amenities that were new / never been seen before / unusual / original. [1]
Learning points: 1. Essentially, the 3 points can be condensed as: Fill the gap, all things / multi-functional in one place, have fun. 2. Point 1, strictly speaking, can feature the context of smaller communities/ more compact neighbourhoods. But team consensus is that we are willing to overlook that. 3. For Point 3, there is no need to paraphrase the list of activities given.	

3. Explain three ways the author uses language in paragraph 5 to convey the failure of larger anchor stores. [3]

From the passage	Suggested answer
presented another catastrophic problem (L31)	1. [Function] The author uses extreme / loaded words like ‘catastrophic’ to [Context] convey their assessment of shopping mall’s great / extreme / shattering collapse // falling out of favour among consumers .
became a liability: dead ends, darkened storefronts, and vacant corridors created eerie, lifeless pockets – and a death spiral . (L32-33)	2. [Function] The author uses hyperbole / language with negative connotations to dramatise / illustrate / emphasise / exaggerate [Context] the way that malls have fallen into disrepair / how the malls are no longer attractive (<i>any reasonable response that shows understanding of malls being a liability</i>)
Fewer tenants, fewer shoppers, decreased income, more unkempt areas. (L33-34)	3. [Function] The author’s repetition of comparative terms ‘fewer’ and ‘more’ highlights / reinforces [Context] the sense of diminished footfall / activity in shopping malls.
Malls became static islands surrounded by seas of asphalt . (L34)	4. [Function] The author employs a metaphor ‘static islands’ to [Context] describe the condition of malls, suggesting that they are left to inactivity and isolation .
When online shopping grew, it stabbed a victim that was already bleeding out . (L35)	5. [Function] The author personifies the shopping mall as a ‘victim ... bleeding out’ [Context] to convey the extreme extent of the mall’s decline/ failure .
Any 3 out of 5 points	
Learning points: Students need to consider specific instances of language use. The statistics given in the last 2 sentences of Paragraph 5 should not be raised in this answer. Students need not label or provide terms for language use but quotes/ textual references need to be present for marker’s understanding. The subsequent explanation needs to present a clear understanding of context.	

4. From lines 40-42, how has the concept of traditional malls changed? [2]

From the passage	Suggested answer
(Inferred: Malls <u>used to</u> offer material things) These younger consumers prefer to spend their money on experiences <u>rather than</u> on material things. (L40-41) Some malls are attempting to weather the storm by offering amenities, experiences, and entertainment to enhance the shopping experience. (L40-42)	1. Malls <u>used to</u> be functional places where people frequented to acquire / purchase what they needed. [1] 2. <u>Now</u>, malls need to offer / provide pleasant encounters, besides an enjoyable / delightful time. [1]
Learning points: Answers should address the question, and not unthinkingly reflect line 40's sentence on younger consumers. Students should adopt the good practice of having relevant opening phrases in their answers. Answers should also present the change clearly.	

5. In what way is the final sentence (line 43-44) an effective conclusion to the author's argument? [1]

From the passage	Suggested answer
But there are no sure bets, and the champions of today's marketplace may be buried in dust and shadows tomorrow. (L43-44)	[Function] It is effective in reiterating / reinforcing [Context] the sense of uncertainty / risk / volatility faced by today's shopping malls. OR [Function] It effectively echoes / rehashes / links back to the main / original / initial argument that [Context] the allure of shopping malls cannot withstand the test of time. [1] OR

	[Function] The final sentence intrigues readers to consider the future of malls [Context] by emphasising how there is uncertainty in the future of malls.
Learning points: Students should be familiar with this question type by now. Good reminder for them to reflect contextual understanding in their answers.	

From Passage 2

6. Summarise the reasons why shopping malls are still relevant.

Write your summary in **no more than 120 words**. [8]

Concept	From the passage	Suggested answer
1. Social space	Shopping malls are social spaces designed within the walls in a cleaner and safer environment (L2-3) changing demographics [...] means more people living in smaller spaces and a greater need for public spaces in which to socialize and congregate (L11-13)	Malls remain relevant by being communal places / venues that are conducive for bonding Accept: area for people to come together / provide opportunity for people to gather and interact
2. Economic growth	malls are centrally capitalist structures. They embody a country's economic growth (L3-4)	while encouraging advancement in wealth and industry Idea of growth must be captured Allow lifting: 'economic'
3. Showing off consumer power	exist to meet consumer demand from a population keen to express its affluence and purchasing power (L4-5)	as they serve the ones who want to flaunt their wealth.
4. Community	shopping malls are the heart and soul of communities (L6)	Malls form the essence of social groups/ encapsulate the spirit of / are focal points for neighbourhoods/ are central to the identity of the neighbourhood // bring life to social groups

5. Social sanctuary	... safer environment (L3) a social sanctuary for teenagers everywhere (L7) malls offer a much-welcomed watering hole, especially in cities where other public spaces are not safe (L13-14)	and have become a place of refuge / (safe) haven / an oasis / shelter / retreat
6. New experience	when consumers visit malls, they are looking for experiences that go well beyond traditional shopping. (L9-10) a sense of novelty (L23)	People visit malls for fresh / new / original encounters .
7. Convenience + Closeness (Proximity)	mixed use developments where they can live, shop and work all within walking distance (L15-16)	and innovative / integrated mall designs mean that people can now do most things in the same place / within close proximity to each other.
8. Blend	Mixed use developments (L15) curated spaces that blend commerce with leisure and spectacle (L18),	integrated malls / malls boost multiple functions become places where business and recreation/ entertainment converge/ are combined/ integrated. <i>No need to capture specific examples of what is blended</i>
9. Observe people	and observe people and society (L19)	People-watching/ watch people go by
10. Well-being	seeking not just products but experiences that enhance their well-being (L21-22)	We no longer want merely to own things , but are drawn to adventures that improve our quality of life .
11. Adaptable space (Potential)	some malls are making greater use of temporary, flexible spaces that can accommodate different uses over time (L24)	Malls are also adaptable and their function can change to meet current needs. // Malls offer various/ varied/ diverse purposes
12. Freedom	experiences offer a special kind of freedom – the freedom to explore, indulge, and forge connections (L26-27)	There is a unique / extraordinary sense of empowerment in malls where one has the liberty/ agency to wander, enjoy the pleasure of building / forming social bonds with others <i>Credit as long as contextual understanding</i>

		<i>is intact.</i> <i>If answer only states 'liberty' – [0]</i>
13. Entertaining	useful and entertaining customer experiences (L29-30)	providing a rich / enjoyable / delightful experience for the consumer / client / payer
14. Offline experiences	a place where people can connect and enjoy individual and collective experiences that are unavailable online . (L30-32)	An avenue / a space where consumers can bond / socialise and receive tailored / bespoke / customised or group services in person .
Learning points: It is good practice to indicate word count.		

Points	1	2	3	4	5-6	7-8	9-10	11+
Marks	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

From all the passages

7. Passage 1 states that the view of shopping malls 'as **sparkling palaces of wonder and delight** was **fading**' (lines 24-25).

Identify **one** specific idea from Passage 3 which can be used to **support** this statement. Justify your answer. [2]

From the passage	Suggested answer
But as the mall's popularity plummeted , its shiny hysterical promises started to seem shabby and worryingly fallible . (Passage 3, L7-8)	Passage 3 asserts that as the shopping mall fell out of favour / became increasingly deserted, people started questioning its inherent worth and assumed potential. [1] [Justification] Both passages agree / support / reinforce the notion that while people were optimistic / feeling positive about the role / function / value of the shopping mall, they soon recognised its obsolescence. [1] <i>Note: Response must capture the notion that shopping malls are losing their appeal or its popularity is waning, despite them being immaculate or attractive places in its heyday.</i>

Learning points:

Marking of intertextual questions: the priority is the comparison here. The comparison (similarity/ 'support' or difference/ 'undermine') ought to be clearly explained with the help of apt discourse markers. If there is a lift of a couple of words, but comparison is clear and overall understanding is intact, then award the marks. The marker exercises discretion to determine if the lifting is excessive.

8. Passage 2 states that 'some malls are **making greater use** of **temporary, flexible spaces** that can **accommodate different uses** over time' (lines 23-25).

Identify **one** specific idea from Passage 3 which can be used to **undermine** this statement. Justify your answer. [2]

From the passage	Suggested answer
Being temples to consumerism, malls were tailor-made to be exactly what they were (Passage 3, L13) Trying to force the issue by repurposing the former makeup counters and dressing rooms into art exhibits or hipster cafes makes the result seem impoverished and weird. (Passage 3, L14-16)	Passage 3 argues that malls are designated places / hallowed venues for shopping / procurement of goods / services, and they are (pecially) customised for it. This contests Passage 2's recognition/ observation that malls are allowing for varied use/ purposes of their retail space. <u>OR</u> Passage 3 asserts that offering another use for obsolete / unutilised infrastructure is almost futile / a strange / bizarre idea. [1] [Justification] because you cannot blindly assume that spaces are inherently adaptable. In contrast / Contradictorily, Passage 2 believes that adapting is vital / integral to ensure that malls can meet our evolving needs and remain relevant. [1]

Learning points:

Marking of intertextual questions: the priority is the comparison here. The comparison (similarity/ 'support' or difference/ 'undermine') ought to be clearly explained with the help of apt discourse markers. If there is a lift of a couple of words, but comparison is clear and overall

understanding is intact, then award the marks. The marker exercises discretion to determine if the lifting is excessive.

9. The reading passages cover a range of views about shopping malls.

How far do you agree that shopping malls are still relevant today?

Support your answer with reference to:

- the ideas and opinions from **at least** one of the reading passages
- examples drawn from your own experience and that of your society. [12]